

Security Incident Policy

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Department	Information Technology
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1. Purpose

This policy explains what employees must do when they suspect or discover a security incident, and how Beacon responds, so that damage is limited and lessons are learned.

2. Scope

This policy applies to all employees, contractors and vendors who use Beacon systems, data or devices, whether in the office or working remotely.

3. What Is a Security Incident

A security incident is any event that may harm the confidentiality, integrity or availability of Beacon information or systems. Examples:

- Lost or stolen laptop, phone or company card
- Phishing emails clicked, or passwords entered on a suspicious site
- Suspected malware or ransomware
- Sharing of passwords or unauthorised access to accounts
- Company or customer data sent to the wrong person or uploaded to an unapproved tool
- Unusual VPN login activity

4. Main Rules

4.1 Reporting

1. Every employee must report a suspected security incident within 2 hours of noticing it.
2. Report to the IT Service Desk (extension 4000, itservicedesk@beacon-tech.example) or the Security team (security@beacon-tech.example). For urgent incidents outside working hours, call the 24x7 Security Hotline at extension 4999.
3. Suspicious emails should be reported using the "Report Phishing" button in the email client. Do not forward them to colleagues.
4. Failure to report an incident is a policy violation. Reporting in good faith will never lead to punishment, even if the employee made a mistake.

4.2 What Employees Should Do

- Stop using the affected device or account if it is safe to do so, and disconnect from the network.

- Do not delete files, emails or logs. Do not attempt to investigate on your own.
- Do not contact attackers or pay any ransom. Payment may only be considered with CEO approval.

4.3 Severity and Response Times

Severity	Example	First Response by Security Team
P1 Critical	Ransomware, confirmed data breach, compromised admin account	Within 30 minutes
P2 High	Compromised employee account, lost laptop with data	Within 2 hours
P3 Medium	Malware on one device, clicked phishing link	Within 1 working day
P4 Low	Policy violation without data exposure	Within 3 working days

4.4 Specific Situations

- **Lost or stolen laptop:** Report within 2 hours. IT will remotely lock and wipe it within 1 hour of the report (see BT-IT-002).
- **Compromised credentials:** Password and MFA are reset immediately (see BT-IT-001).
- **Lost corporate card:** Inform the bank and also notify Finance within 2 hours (see BT-FIN-003).
- **Incident while working remotely:** Disconnect from VPN, and report within 2 hours as for any incident.

4.5 Response and Review

- The Security team leads the response and keeps the reporter informed.
- A post-incident review is held within 5 working days for P1 and P2 incidents.
- If personal or customer data is involved, the Legal team is informed within 24 hours, and notifications to customers or regulators are made as required by law.
- HR is informed where employee conduct is involved.

4.6 Training

All employees must complete security awareness training within 30 days of joining and once every year. Simulated phishing tests are run regularly.

5. Exceptions

- Incidents involving senior leadership or HR data are reported directly to the Information Security Officer and the CEO.
- The Information Security Officer may change the severity level of an incident based on the situation.

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Synthetic document created for a technology prototype.